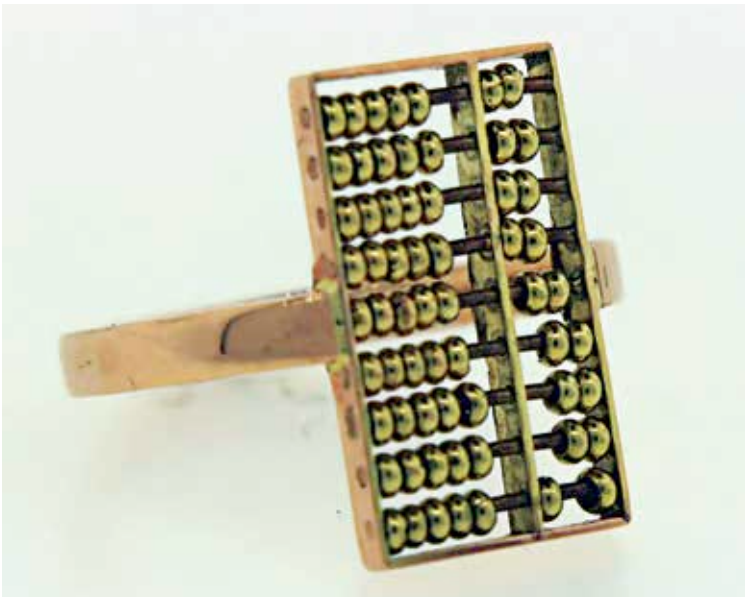


us take a moment to look back at what it these geeky wearable devices that our current generation is enjoying actually means for us.

We might be thinking James Bond or Minority Report, but the reality is that we've been wearing technology for thousands of years- Armor, Eyeglasses, and prosthetics are all examples of wearable tech. They are extremely useful and everything, but they're also steeped social symbolism. They help us curate our identities offline by allowing us to establish our normalcy and sense of community. For example, by putting on armor we used to claim membership with a group and broadcast that to the general public. We strengthen the ties of the group and enhance its overall fitness through wearable technologies.

Wearable technology is usually thought of by the layman as dating back before the 1900's but If we really want to get particular with it, in 1650, China's Qing Dynasty invented the Abacus Ring, a miniscule example in the history of wearable tech. the ring is a calculator that features a 1.2cm long, 0.7cm wide abacus that sits on the finger. While the abacus ring may not be able to make phone calls, it goes to show that wearable technology might not be as radical a concept as one would think.



The Abacus Ring of yore